Pen Pals

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at https://archiveofourown.org/works/77015736.

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Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora & Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra), Light Hope (She-Ra), Scorpia (She-Ra), Entrapta (She-Ra), Glimmer (She-Ra), Bow (She-Ra)

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Modern AU, Canon Species, Mild Langauge, Kid Fic (They're in Junior High), Pen Pals, Dungeons and Dragons (Mentioned)

Language:
English

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Part 6 of SPOP Discord Prompts

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Pen Pals

by AuthorWithoutaName

Summary

Catra huffs and begins scribbling down some letters. The school is stupid. Her teacher is stupid. This whole freaking assignment is stupid! Sure, she'll do the assignment but she's gonna half-ass it.

In 7th grade, Catra is forced to write to a randomly assigned pen pal. Over the course of the year, she begins to genuinely look forward to those weekly letters with her new faraway friend.

(Or... Catra and Adora become pen pals! Based on the SPOP Creative Flex server's weekly prompt, the prompt being: "Letters, writing".)

Notes

Hi, everyone! Happy New Year! First new SPOP fic for me in the year 2026 (Also my 30th posted fic on AO3, yay!)! Hopefully ya'll enjoy this one-shot!

See the end of the work for more notes

September 15th

Catra huffed. Her ears were flat against her head. The lead of her pencil drummed against the blank page. Based off of the constant scribbling, it didn't sound like her classmates were struggling with this assignment as much as she was.

This was stupid. This whole freaking assignment was stupid! The dull thump of shoes on the tiled floor caused one of her ears to perk up and flicker towards the source of the sound. No doubt Ms. Weaver was wandering around the classroom. The old crone was probably looking over everyone's letters. Knowing her, she was probably judging them. She was a harsh bitch (a word her mothers didn't like her using but it was true! Weaver was a bitch! Even one of her moms had her that!).

She should probably write something before Weaver got to her. (And something snide to her, the witch!).

Hello.

Lame. So lame! One word was better than nothing though. She continued to write:

You're my stupid pen pal, I guess. I'm being told I have to write this. I have to spend 15 minutes of my week writing these stupid letters.

This assignment is stupid. My teacher is stupid. THIS WHOLE FREAKING THING IS STUPID!!!

"Augh!" She wanted to throw her pencil at the wall. She wanted to crumble up this stupid letter and toss it out the window. Or rip it all up and throw it up in the air like confetti. That would make class more entertaining at least. It would probably also get her sent to the principal's office (again). The school year had just begun, who knows what would happen if she got in trouble this early.

The footsteps faded. A shadow fell on her and she stiffened, her previous bravo having vanished.

"Having trouble, are we?" came the cold, judgemental voice of Ms. Weaver.

Catra's hands bolted to the paper, desperately trying to hide the contents of her letter from Weaver. A part of her worried that she was too late, that Weaver already read the line where she called her *stupid*. She had to survive nearly a year with this witch, it wouldn't do to piss her off this early.

"No, Ms. Weaver," Catra replied, careful to keep her voice devoid of any emotion.
"Good." Ms. Weaver didn't move though. Catra felt the old witch's cold eyes on her; searching her, watching her, for any sign of disobedience.

Catra fought the urge to squirm. Her skin and fur itched. It took every ounce of self control to not let her tail twitch as it usually did when she was stressed. What good would that do? None.

Ms. Weaver lingered for a few moments longer before finally stalking off, no doubt to harass another student. Catra breathed a sigh of relief. She took a deep breath and then began writing again:

My name is Catra. You don't need my last name. Why would you? You don't need to know my school either. It's dumb that's even a suggestion for these dumbass letters.

You probably won't even write back. Why should I even bother?

Signed- Catra

She finished the letter with a quick sketch. Her face, with one eye shut and her tongue sticking out.

***

September 15th

Hello! You're my pen pal! My name is Adora!

Adora brought the pencil up from the paper and put the eraser end in her mouth as she reread those three sentences. She grimaced as she tasted the rubber of the eraser and quickly took the pencil out of her mouth. Why had she done that? She did that a lot without thought. Her sister always got onto her for doing that home.

"Everything okay?"

Adora stiffened and glanced up to see her teacher, Ms. Hope standing next to her, peering over her shoulder and at the letter.

"Yes, Ms. Hope," Adora responded, giving her teacher a small smile. As always, Ms. Hope didn't return the smile, she never did. Honestly, Adora wasn't sure where she stood with her teacher, if she was a good student, or an annoyance. Ms. Hope walked away without a word. Adora let out a breath she hadn't even realized she had been holding and she looked at her letter once more.

Was three exclamation points too much? She wanted her pen pal to think she was excited to talk to her. She sighed and began to write again, she only had fifteen minutes to get this assignment done.
My name is Adora. I won't give you my last name because stranger danger. I'm in the 7th grade.

I play sports in my spare time. I just made my school's soccer team and I've been training with them. We haven't had any games yet.

She tapped her pencil against her desk. What else could she say? How long should the first letter be? All around her, she could hear the sound of scribbling. Her classmates didn't seem to have any trouble with this assignment, so why was she struggling? Maybe it was best to be honest? She took her pencil and began to write again.

I'm not sure what else to say. We have fifteen minutes to write. Oh! This summer my friend Bow introduced us (me and my other friend Glimmer) to some game called Dungeons and Dragons. It was cool! I don't know if you've played it, or if you're into that sort of thing, but it's super fun! I played as a paladin. Glimmer was a wizard. Mermista (another friend) was a druid. Sea Hawk (one of Bow's other friends) was a bard. And this other friend of Bow's was an artificer. I can't remember her name though…

Anyway! The story Bow came up with was super cool! So we started off in the woods and–

For the next fifteen minutes, Adora wrote (in great detail) about the campaign she played in throughout the summer. It was only afterwards that she realized that *maybe* her new pen pal wasn't into Dungeons and Dragons but it was too late to change the contents of the letter then…

***

September 22nd

"My pen pal is a nerd," Catra sighed in exasperation.

She set her tray on the table and sat down beside Scorpia on her left.

"Why do you say that?" Scorpia asked, curiously. Catra sighed again and slid her backpack off her back and set it beside her and immediately began to dig into it. She fished out the letter she had received that morning in homeroom.

"Because they're a nerd," she huffed, practically shoving the letter into Scorpia's pincher. Scorpia took the letter and immediately began to read it.

"Oh! Dungeons and Dragons! Hey, Entrapta!" Scorpia turned her head towards Entrapta, who was sitting on her right.
"Yes?"

"Didn't you say that you played Dungeons and Dragons during the summer?"

"Oh yeah! I introduced my friend to it and he wanted to try his hand at being a DM and–"

I'm surrounded by nerds… Catra thought irritably to herself. She tuned out Scorpia and Entrapta's conversation, focusing instead on the (almost inedible looking slop before her). She was right, this pen pal shit was absolutely stupid.

***

September 22nd

Adora glared at the blank piece of paper as she tried to think of something (anything!) to write. Unfortunately, her pen pal, Catra, hadn't said much. She glanced over at the letter she had received during homeroom and double checked. Yup. Nothing. She had gotten Catra's name. She had learned that Catra didn't even want to do this assignment… And… That was all Adora knew about her writing buddy.

Adora sighed in defeat. What would they possibly talk about for the whole school year? She hoped that Catra's next letter would have something. Something that they could spend the whole semester writing back and forth to each other about. A part of her doubted that though.

It wouldn't be a lot but Adora figured if she wrote something, she had at least completed the assignment for this week.

Hi, Catra! It's nice to meet you! Do you have any hobbies? Do you play sports or read or watch anything?

Adora huffed after she reread the meager sentences she could muster. Maybe Catra was right. Maybe this assignment was stupid.

***

September 29th

Do you have any hobbies?

Catra stared blankly at the empty page in front of her. A part of her felt guilty. Adora had clearly spent more time on her letter. And even now, she was trying to reach out, probably trying to salvage this stupid assignment. After taking a moment to think, Catra picked her pencil up and began to write:

I draw. I watch TV.

What else did she do? During the summer, Entrapta had taught her and Scorpia about some card game. It was *kinda* dorky. Maybe this Adora knew about it. Maybe they could talk about it instead of Dungeons and Dragons for the rest of the school year. At least then, Catra would know what they were talking about.

A friend of mine introduced me to this trading card game called–

Suddenly, it wasn't a struggle to write. Suddenly, it was easy. The words poured out. She was still writing when Ms. Weaver had announced that their fifteen minutes were up. She folded up the letter, slid it into the envelope and handed it to Ms. Weaver as she stalked through the classroom, for once feeling a tiny bit proud of herself.

***

November 10th

Hey, Catra!

Happy (Late) Birthday! I wish you had mentioned that your birthday was in October earlier! I would have gotten you a present on time. Anyway, I found this card at the local shop and got it for you, I hope you like it!

Catra had found the card first and had taken the time to study it carefully before reading Adora's letter. The creature on it looked like a dragon. Its mouth was open, orange and fire spilled out of its jaws. Blue wings were outspread. Truthfully, she already had similar cards to this one. *Similar*. Why did this one look so different? She glanced back at the letter and kept on reading:

It's a vintage card. I did some research and it was printed the same year you were born! Anyway, happy birthday again!

- Adora :)

Dork. Catra smiled. For the first couple of weeks, she had dreaded writing these stupid letters every week… Now… She actually looked forward to them. Last week she had even bought a beginner's guide to Dungeons and Dragons with some of the money her mothers had given her for her birthday. For some reason.

When was Adora's birthday? Since Adora had gotten her something, maybe she should get Adora something. That was only fair, after all.

***

January, 19th

Hey, Adora

Happy Birthday!

Adora's face immediately brightened. A warm, large smile tugged her face as she continued to read.

So, since you got me that card, I made you something.

Her eyebrows rose in confusion for a moment. Catra had made her something? Her eyes fluttered to the bottom of the page and they grew wide. There was a drawing. A girl dressed just like a Paladin. Under the drawing was a name: *She-Ra*.

She remembered! Catra remembered the character she had made for Bow's game last summer. The campaign she had spent time (probably too much time) talking about in her first letter with Catra. She glanced back up to finish reading the letter:

Hope you like it! I had to use old letters to get an idea on what your character looked like. (By the way, She-Ra? Weird name but okay…)

Anyway, I hope you have a great birthday, Adora!

As always, Catra ended her letter with a tiny sketch of her sticking her tongue out. Adora seemed to like it. At least, she had complimented the drawing once, awhile back.

***

April 27th

There were only a few weeks left in the school year. There were only a few weeks left for her to write Catra. The thought filled her with dread (and for some reason, a bit of anxiety). Adora wasn't sure why though.

"You know, you could ask her if she wants to meet up sometime during the summer," Glimmer said, bringing Adora out of her thoughts.

They were in the dining hall, trays with whatever semi-edible junk Bright Moon Jr. High had decided to serve them that day. As always, Adora was sitting next to Glimmer, who was between her and Bow. Across from them sat Mermista and Sea Hawk.

"Who are you talking about?" Mermista asked, giving Adora a quizzical glance.
"Her pen pal," Bow cut in before Adora or Glimmer could answer. He peered around Glimmer, his eyes meeting Adora's.

"Do you know if she lives in the area? Or at least near the area?" he asked.

Adora slouched in her spot. She wasn't. She wished she knew but neither of them had (for good reason) mentioned where they lived or what school they went to. She was pretty sure that was against the rules of the pen pal assignment anyway. (At least, she thought it was).

"No… I don't," Adora sighed. If she was lucky, her pen pal went to Horde Jr. High. It was *in* the area.

"Any way you can find out?" Bow asked.

No. At least, she didn't think so. Adora sighed again. Maybe she could give Catra her email address? Was that allowed?

***

May 11th

Hey, Catra!

So, I guess this is the last letter I get to write you. My teacher said that the program actually ends a couple of weeks before school ends (I thought it lasted the whole school year). It's been fun writing to you! Maybe we'll meet again someday!

Signed, Adora

She hoped that they would meet someday. She hoped that with every fiber of her being…

***

July 11th

"This is gonna be lame," Catra hissed under her breath.

A couple of weeks ago, Entrapta had begged her and Scorpia to join a dungeons and dragons campaign her friend was hosting. Apparently two people had dropped out last minute, and they needed to replace those players. Catra wasn't sure why Entrapta

had asked her. She was still trying to figure out why she had said yes to begin with.

"Come on, Catra, I'm sure it'll be fun!" Scorpia tried to encourage her.

Catra's ears flattened against her head. Despite Adora's raving about the game, it still seemed way too dorky.

"I think you'll like it, Catra!" Entrapta exclaimed. She spun around and was now walking backwards. Her face was spread into a huge grin. "The character I made for you is super cool! She's a rogue and–"

Entrapta rambled on, too fast for Catra to catch every word (not that she was even really trying). One day. That's all she had promised Entrapta. One day to play this stupid game.

***

"Hey, Entrapta!" A boy had answered the door. He was grinning and seemed overly excited to see Entrapta. It was nice. Aside from her and Scorpia, Entrapta didn't have many friends at school. He peered past Entrapta, his gaze then falling upon her and Scorpia.

"You guys must be Entrapta's friends. It's nice to meet you! My name's Bow! Please, come in and make yourselves at home," he stepped aside to let them in.

Bow… Bow… For some reason, that name felt familiar.

"Game's set up in the dining room, just straight ahead. My dads prefer no shoes out of the entry way, so…" His words trailed off as he gestured to the pile of shoes beside the front door. Scorpia bent down to undo the laces on her boots. Luckily for Catra, she never wore shoes, so she sauntered past everyone and made her way to the dining room.

Entrapta had said something about snacks being provided, and possibly a pizza. She was starving. And Bow had said to make themselves at home… Two other people were seated at the large, round table in the dining room.

"Hi," one of them, a blonde girl waved at her.

"Hey," the other, a shorter girl with pink waved also.

"You must be one of Entrapta's friends," the blonde girl said. Catra nodded and took a seat at the table.

The blonde girl leaned across the table, reaching a hand out for Catra to take.

"My name's Adora," she said with a warm smile.

Adora? Adora!

Catra's eyes widened.

"I'm Glimmer," the other girl said. Unlike Adora, she didn't offer her hand. But that was okay, because Catra's focus was still on Adora. Could it be…?

"Umm… What's your–?"

"What's your character's name?" Catra interrupted.

"W-what?"

"Your character, what's its name?" Catra asked again, this time with more urgency.

"Umm… She-Ra… She's a–"

"Catra," she said suddenly. After a moment, she heard a startled sound from nearby, probably that other girl, Glimmer. Adora had a confused look on her face, as if she was thinking. She could pinpoint the exact moment when it fell into place and Adora's eyes lit up.

“Catra?!”

Catra gave a smile. "Hey, Adora."

End Notes

Honestly, I couldn't think of an ending and went with an open/abrupt ending. Thank you so much for reading! Any comments and/or kudos are always appreciated! Until next time!

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!